

As I went down to the river to pray

Text: African American Spiritual

Music: African American Spiritual

AS I WENT DOWN TO THE RIVER TO PRAY irregular

The musical score is written for a single melodic line in treble clef, key of D major (three sharps), and 2/2 time. The melody is characterized by a mix of 2/2 and 3/2 time signatures, creating an irregular feel. The lyrics are written below the notes, with some words hyphenated. Above the staff, guitar chord diagrams are provided for each measure, with fingerings indicated by numbers 1-4. The score ends with a double bar line and the word 'Fine'.

As I went down to the riv-er to pray, stud-y-in' a-bout that good old way,
and who shall wear the star - ry crown, good Lord, show me the way.
1 Oh, sis - ters, let's go down, let's go down, come on down.
Oh, sis - ters, let's go down, down to the riv-er to pray.

E (1 4 2) **B** (3 2 1 1) **E** (1 4 2) **B** (3 2 1 1) **A** (2 1) **E** (1 4 2) **B** (3 2 1 1) **E** (1 4 2) **A** (2 1) **E** (1 4 2) **D.C.**

2. Oh, brothers, ...

3. Oh, children, ...

4. Oh, sinners, ...